

Version control platform

Git is meant to be a low-level version control system that can be used as a base for another version control system

Text, not binary

Most version control systems are intended to be used with text code, and as such are not very efficient while handling binary files



Service	SourceForge	Google Code	GitHub	BitBucket	Gitorious	Launchpad	CodePlex
Owner	Geeknet, Inc.	Google	GitHub, Inc.	Atlassian	Gitorious AS	Canonical	Microsoft
Website	sourceforge.net	code.google.com	github.com	bitbucket.org	gitorious.org	launchpad.net	codeplex.com
Supported revision control systems (RCS)	CVS, SVN, Git, Bazaar, Mercurial	SVN, Mercurial	Git	Mercurial	Git	Bazaar	TFS, Mercurial
Public API supported	Read-Only	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Project management features							
Wiki	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Issue Tracking	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Web interface for RCS	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Project Downloads	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes
Online Forking	No	No	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Other	Shell access, choice of blog, wiki, bug tracker, analytics	Integration with Google Groups	POST-Receive hooks	Custom domain names	Multiple repositories per project	Blueprint, Answers, online builds for Ubuntu, Open Source	Advertisements on project page for funding projects
Free usage limit	None	25 Projects, 2GB downloads and code repository	300 MB soft limit	5 Users for private projects	None	None	200MB per file for downloads
Popular Projects hosted on service	ffmpeg, MinGW, LAME, 7-zip	Android, Chromium, Chromium OS	jQuery, Perl, Ruby on Rails	Pylons, TortoiseHG, OGRE	openSUSE, Qt, XBMC	Ubuntu	Silverlight Toolkit, Iron-Python

custom domain. So if you have your own website for a project, it's Bitbucket page can be accessed <http://hg.myproject.com> or something similar.

Suitable for:

- Open and closed-source projects
- Personal small-scale closed-source projects
- Closed-source projects where number of contributor is fixed
- People working on Open Source software no ready to be open yet

CodePlex

CodePlex is Microsoft's own service for hosting open source projects for free. It only allows for open source projects, although some Microsoft licences that are allowed to be used are not compliant with the open source initiative.

CodePlex offers the usual Wiki and issue tracking features, along with support for hosting project downloads. CodePlex also offers a discussions feature for each project. Unlike the other services we have mentioned, CodePlex has inbuilt support for displaying advertisements on project pages that can be used to fund the development of your open source applications.

Being a Microsoft service it supports Microsoft's revision control system, Team Foundation Server.

Suitable for:

- Open source projects
- Projects using / derives from Microsoft applications
- People targeting Windows
- People already using Team Foundation Server for their code

Gitorious

Gitorious is an open source code hosting website that is itself open-source, with its source code hosted on itself! Accessing <http://gitorious.org/gitorious> gives you access to the Gitorious source code, allowing you to clone / fork it and contribute to its development. This also means you can host it on your own server.

Gitorious is free for all open source projects, and does not mention any storage or other limits.

The way repositories are handled in Gitorious is a little different from other services. On Gitorious, you create a new project, and each project may have multiple repositories. You can have a wiki at the project level, such

that it is shared between multiple repositories for the same project. Gitorious however does not include a bug tracker and doesn't support creating a project page.

Suitable for:

- Open Source projects
- Large projects requiring multiple repositories
- People working on openSUSE-related projects
- People wanting a free open source SCM on their own server

Launchpad

Launchpad is a service by Canonical, the company behind Ubuntu, that is used for hosting all their open source projects. The Launchpad service code itself has been open sourced by Canonical, such that it can be run on your own server.

Other than code repository hosting, Launchpad offers a number of useful features, some of which are unique to the service. Other than Bug / Issue tracking, Launchpad also offers a specialized software for tracking specifications and features called Blueprints; it also offers an online tool to help devel-